

MODULE 5: COOKING & CAMPCRAFT

5.1. FOOD PREPARATION & COOKING OVER FIRE

Heat treatment improves digestibility and, more importantly, reduces the risk from parasites and bacteria present in raw meat and plants.

Camp cooking techniques

- **Stone boiling:** used when metal cookware is unavailable. The manual recommends heating suitable dry stones and transferring them with wooden tongs into water held in a wooden or bark container, while warning against river-bottom stones because trapped moisture may cause them to fracture or burst.
- **Ash / clay cooking:** fish or small game is wrapped in about 2 cm of wet clay and placed in hot embers; the hardened clay is then broken away with skin/scales.
- **Improvised smoking:** thin strips of meat are hung above slow hardwood smoke for 12-24 hours.

5.2. CAMP LAYOUT & ERGONOMICS

The manual uses a '4W' rule for evaluating campsite hazards.

Factor	Hazard	Safety procedure
Wood	Dead overhead branches ('widowmakers') and dead trunks	Look up before pitching camp; avoid camping beneath unstable dead trees.
Wind	Wind chill and shelter damage	Orient the shelter away from prevailing wind and use natural terrain as a windbreak.
Water	Flash floods and insects	Do not camp in dry riverbeds or directly on the bank; the manual recommends roughly 30-50 m from water.
Wild animals	Feeding areas and game trails	Do not camp on animal trails; keep the cooking area about 100 m from the sleeping area.

5.3. HYGIENE & FOOD SAFETY IN THE FIELD

The manual identifies poor camp hygiene as a major cause of food poisoning and loss of operational capability.

- **Latrine / cathole:** dig individual waste holes about 15-20 cm deep and at least 60 m from water sources and camp; cover after use.
- **Hand washing:** the source recommends washing before food preparation with filtered water and campfire ash.
- **Cookware cleaning:** hot water with fine sand or ash is described as an abrasive cleaning method to remove food residue.